

Smart English Expression Bank

Reading, Content, Mysteries, Theories, Tech & Real-Life Conversations

Made for a curious data analyst

Use this material to sound more natural when you talk about what you read, watch, think, investigate, cook, discuss with friends, and notice about people.

Most of the material is in English. The columns called Sentido, Uso, Função, Estrutura or Sensação are in Portuguese to help you remember the idea quickly.

Your goal is not to memorize everything. Your goal is to choose useful chunks and use them in real conversations.

How to use this material

A simple routine for turning expressions into real speaking.

Step	Uso	What to do
1. Notice	perceber o chunk	Choose 3 to 5 expressions from one section. Read the examples out loud.
2. Personalize	trazer para a sua vida	Change the examples so they talk about your job, routine, friends, food, shows or theories.
3. Reuse	repetir em contextos diferentes	Use the same expression in a new situation. Example: I tend to read... / I tend to watch... / I tend to avoid...
4. Expand	sair da resposta curta	Add one reason, one example and one opinion. This makes your answer sound more fluent.

The easiest speaking formula

Opinion + reason + example + small conclusion

I feel like people still read a lot, but in different formats. For example, I read Reddit discussions and social media posts almost every day. So maybe the habit did not disappear - the format changed.

Mini challenge

- Choose one expression from any section.
- Create one sentence about your routine.
- Create another sentence about technology, mysteries or behavior.

Quick map

Use this page when you do not know where to start.

Section	Função	Use it when you want to...
1. What you consume	falar de hábitos	talk about videos, posts, manga, news, podcasts, reviews or Reddit threads
2. Routine moments	encaixar na rotina	say when and why you consume something
3. Stories and true crime	comentar histórias	talk about plot, characters, tension, endings and why a story is good
4. Comparing content	comparar preferências	explain why you prefer one format over another
5. Smart opinions	dar opinião com nuance	agree, disagree, balance ideas and sound more mature
6. Human behavior	interpretar pessoas	say what a situation suggests or reveals
7. Speculating now	criar hipóteses no presente	use may, might and must about current situations
8. Investigating the past	criar hipóteses no passado	use may have, might have and must have
9. Updating theories	mudar a teoria	react when new evidence appears
10. Tech and society	falar de futuro	discuss AI, jobs, remote work and social changes
11. People and lifestyle	descrever comportamento	describe habits, routines and personality patterns
12. Food, home and friends	small talk natural	talk about staying home, going out, eating and cooking

Best way to study: do not read the whole PDF in one day. Pick one section per class or per week.

1. Talking about what you consume

Use these chunks to talk about videos, manga, posts, news, reviews, podcasts, true crime and anything you read or watch online.

Expression	Uso / Sentido	Natural example
I've always been into...	para falar de um interesse antigo	I've always been into mysteries and psychological stories.
Lately, I've been consuming more...	para falar de uma fase atual	Lately, I've been consuming more true crime videos and Reddit discussions.
I tend to read/watch/listen to...	hábito natural, sem parecer regra fixa	I tend to watch something light after work.
I usually... when...	ligar hábito a uma situação	I usually read short posts when I need a break from work.
I end up reading/watching...	algo que acontece meio sem planejar	I end up reading comments when I want honest opinions.
I'm more into X than Y.	comparar preferências	I'm more into psychological stories than romantic ones.
It depends on my mood.	resposta natural quando muda de acordo com o dia	It depends on my mood. Sometimes I want something deep, sometimes I just want comfort.
I like things that feel...	explicar a sensação do conteúdo	I like things that feel immersive but not too heavy.
I read/watch mostly for...	explicar motivação	I watch documentaries mostly for curiosity and entertainment.
I got used to...	hábito que virou normal	I got used to reading online instead of buying physical books.
I stopped... because...	explicar mudança de hábito	I stopped reading long articles at night because I couldn't focus.

Personalize it

- Complete: Lately, I've been consuming more...
- Complete: I end up reading/watching... when...
- Complete: I'm more into... than... because...

2. Routine moments

These chunks help you explain when something happens in your real life.

Expression	Uso / Sentido	Natural example
while waiting for...	enquanto espera algo	I usually scroll through short posts while waiting for an appointment.
on a rainy Sunday afternoon	situação bem visual e natural	On a rainy Sunday afternoon, I like staying home and watching a mystery documentary.
when I have nothing planned	quando o dia está livre	When I have nothing planned, I might cook something and watch a show.
during my lunch break	rotina de trabalho	During my lunch break, I sometimes watch quick videos or read comments.
after a long day at work	depois de um dia cansativo	After a long day at work, I don't want anything too complex.
before going to sleep	antes de dormir	Before going to sleep, I avoid heavy content because I overthink.
when I don't want to focus on something too heavy	quando você quer algo leve	I watch slice-of-life videos when I don't want to focus on something too heavy.
when I want someone's personal perspective	quando quer opinião real de pessoas	I read Reddit threads when I want someone's personal perspective.
when I want to understand the reasons behind something	quando quer entender o porquê	I look for long discussions when I want to understand the reasons behind something.
when I need a break from dashboards	adaptado para a vida dela	When I need a break from dashboards, I watch something funny or mysterious.

Make it real

- Say one thing you do during your lunch break.
- Say one thing you avoid before going to sleep.
- Say one thing you like doing after a long day at work.

3. Talking about stories, manga, true crime and shows

Use these words to sound more specific when you talk about a story.

Expression	Sentido	Natural example
storytelling	forma como a história é contada	The storytelling is simple, but it works really well.
plot twist	reviravolta	The plot twist made me rethink everything.
character development	evolução do personagem	The character development feels realistic.
pacing	ritmo da história	The pacing was a little slow at first, but then it got better.
cliffhanger	final que deixa suspense	The episode ended with a cliffhanger, so I had to continue.
world-building	construção do universo da história	The world-building is what keeps me hooked.
visual storytelling	narrativa feita pelas imagens	Manga can be powerful because of the visual storytelling.
dialogue-heavy	com muitos diálogos	I like dialogue-heavy stories when the conversations feel natural.
emotional tension	tensão emocional	The emotional tension made the story more intense.
slice of life	história do cotidiano	I like slice-of-life stories when I want something calm.
psychological story	história com foco na mente/comportamento	Psychological stories make me think about human behavior.
action-driven story	história movida por ação	Action-driven stories are fun, but sometimes I miss deeper characters.
immersive	algo que te puxa para dentro	The story is so immersive that I forget I'm studying English.
engaging	envolvente	It's engaging because every episode gives you a new clue.

Ready-made chunks

Chunk	Uso / Sentido
It keeps me hooked.	quando algo prende sua atenção
I got emotionally attached to the story.	quando você se envolve emocionalmente
That completely changed the way I saw the character.	quando uma informação muda sua visão
I kept reading because I wanted to know what happened next.	para explicar curiosidade e continuidade
It doesn't even feel like studying anymore.	quando o inglês vira consumo natural

4. Comparing content and preferences

Use this when you want to compare books, manga, webtoons, articles, social media posts, videos or podcasts.

Structure	Uso / Sentido	Natural example
Compared to...	comparar duas coisas	Compared to traditional books, manga feels easier to consume.
Unlike...	mostrar diferença	Unlike academic texts, online discussions feel more spontaneous.
Instead of...	trocar uma escolha por outra	Instead of forcing myself to read long books, I read things that keep my attention.
X feels more... than Y	comparar sensação	Manga feels more visual and immersive than normal articles.
It's not that..., it's just that...	corrigir uma ideia sem negar tudo	It's not that I hate reading. It's just that I prefer faster formats.
The format changed more than the habit itself.	ideia forte do material	People still read, but the format changed more than the habit itself.
People still..., but now they...	mostrar mudança de comportamento	People still look for stories, but now they consume them in different ways.
I prefer X because it feels...	dar preferência com motivo	I prefer podcasts because they feel practical during my routine.

Compare quickly

- Compare reading a book and reading online comments.
- Compare watching true crime and watching light content before bed.
- Compare working from home and working at an office.

5. Giving smart opinions

These expressions help you sound balanced, not robotic or too simple.

Expression	Função	Natural example
I feel like...	opinião natural	I feel like people read more than they realize.
I'd say that...	opinião com um pouco mais de segurança	I'd say short-form content changed the way we focus.
From my perspective...	opinião mais organizada	From my perspective, AI is useful, but people still need critical thinking.
I can see why people think that...	concordância parcial	I can see why people think social media ruined attention span.
At the same time...	contraste	At the same time, short content can be practical.
I don't necessarily agree with that.	discordância natural	I don't necessarily agree with that because the situation is more complex.
That makes sense, but...	discordar sem ficar seco	That makes sense, but I think it depends on the person.
It depends on...	opinião equilibrada	It depends on the type of content and the moment of the day.
One clear example is...	dar exemplo	One clear example is how people read long Reddit threads without noticing.
In many cases...	generalizar com cuidado	In many cases, people choose content that fits their routine.

Speaking frame

I feel like... + because... + One clear example is... + At the same time...

I feel like AI can make work faster because it helps with repetitive tasks. One clear example is data cleaning or summarizing information. At the same time, humans still need to interpret the results.

6. Interpreting human behavior

This is for smart conversations about people, habits, social media, relationships, work and strange decisions.

Expression	Uso / Sentido	Natural example
This suggests that...	interpretar o que algo indica	This suggests that people don't hate reading - they hate some formats.
Maybe it's not that..., it's more that...	reformular uma ideia	Maybe it's not that people are lazy. It's more that they are overstimulated.
This could mean that...	dar uma interpretação possível	This could mean that she needed space from everyone.
It says a lot about...	mostrar que algo revela uma coisa maior	It says a lot about how technology changed our habits.
It reveals something about...	falar de algo escondido	It reveals something about the way people look for validation online.
It points to...	indicar direção/conclusão	It points to a bigger problem with attention span.
There might be a deeper reason behind it.	sugerir uma causa mais profunda	There might be a deeper reason behind why she deleted everything.
People don't always realize how much...	falar de algo inconsciente	People don't always realize how much vocabulary they absorb online.
Without realizing it...	sem perceber	Without realizing it, she was learning English through repetition.
It is not random.	quando parece ter padrão	It is not random. People choose content that matches their emotional state.

Human behavior practice

- What does it suggest when someone deletes all social media?
- What does it say about people when they read comments for hours?
- What might be the deeper reason behind people liking true crime?

7. Speculating about now

Use may, might and must when you are creating theories about a current situation.

Structure	Sensação	Use it like this	Natural example
may	possibilidade com alguma base	Subject + may + verb	She may be busy with work.
might	possibilidade mais especulativa	Subject + might + verb	She might be avoiding social media.
must	dedução forte	Subject + must + verb	She must be exhausted after working full-time.

Situation	May	Might	Must
A coworker is not answering messages.	She may be in a meeting.	She might be avoiding people.	She must be busy with a deadline.
A restaurant is completely empty.	It may be too early.	It might be too expensive.	It must be closed or almost closing.
A friend keeps changing cities.	She may enjoy new experiences.	She might be running away from something.	She must hate feeling stuck.
Someone deletes all social media.	They may need privacy.	They might be starting over.	They must be tired of being seen all the time.
AI tools are everywhere now.	They may improve productivity.	They might replace some tasks.	They must change the way people work.

Quick reminder: may sounds possible, might sounds more speculative, and must sounds like a strong conclusion.

8. Investigating the past

Use this when something already happened and you are trying to explain it.

Structure	Sensação	Use it like this	Natural example
may have + past participle	possibilidade com alguma base	She may have missed her flight.	She may have had a problem at work.
might have + past participle	possibilidade mais aberta	He might have turned off his phone.	He might have planned everything in secret.
must have + past participle	dedução forte no passado	She must have overslept.	He must have wanted to disappear for a while.

Clue language	Sentido	Example in a theory
clues	pistas	The clues don't make sense at first.
evidence	evidência	The evidence points to a planned disappearance.
the front door was open	a porta estava aberta	Someone may have left the front door open.
nothing was stolen	nada foi roubado	If nothing was stolen, it might not have been a robbery.
unread messages	mensagens não lidas	She must have been offline because she had 57 unread messages.
missed calls	chamadas perdidas	Three missed calls suggest that people were worried.
his phone was turned off	o celular estava desligado	He might have turned off his phone on purpose.
a one-way ticket	passagem só de ida	She may have bought a one-way ticket because she wanted to start over.
he returned looking relaxed	voltou parecendo relaxado	He must have gone somewhere to disconnect.

9. Updating theories when evidence changes

This is one of the best speaking skills: change your idea naturally when you get new information.

Expression	Uso / Sentido	Natural example
At first, I thought...	primeira teoria	At first, I thought she had just quit because she was stressed.
But now that I know...	nova informação	But now that I know she sold her apartment, I think it was planned.
That changes my theory.	mudar opinião	That changes my theory. Maybe she wanted a completely new life.
Based on this new clue...	usar uma pista como base	Based on this new clue, she might have bought the ticket in advance.
This makes it more likely that...	algo ficou mais provável	This makes it more likely that she wanted to disappear on purpose.
I'd rule out the idea that...	descartar uma hipótese	I'd rule out the idea that it was just an accident.
The evidence keeps changing.	as informações mudam	The evidence keeps changing, so my theory is not final.
My final conclusion is that...	fechar raciocínio	My final conclusion is that she must have planned everything.

Theory chain

At first, I thought she had just quit her job because she was stressed. But now that I know she sold her apartment and bought a one-way ticket, that changes my theory. Based on this new clue, she might have planned to start a new life. My final conclusion is that she must have wanted to disappear from her old routine.

Create your own theory chain

- Clue 1: A woman suddenly left her job.
- Clue 2: She sold her apartment.
- Clue 3: She bought a one-way ticket.
- Clue 4: She hasn't posted online in six months.

10. Talking about tech, AI, jobs and society

Because you work with data, these chunks can help you talk about the future in a more natural way.

Expression	Uso / Sentido	Natural example
AI might change the way people work.	possibilidade grande sobre trabalho	AI might change the way data analysts work.
Some repetitive tasks may disappear.	mudança em tarefas repetitivas	Some repetitive tasks may disappear faster than people expect.
People may need to focus more on...	falar de nova habilidade	Data analysts may need to focus more on interpretation than manual tasks.
Remote work might change...	futuro do trabalho	Remote work might change the way people choose where to live.
Technology can make people more..., but also more...	opinião equilibrada	Technology can make people more connected, but also more isolated.
It depends on how people use it.	resposta madura	AI can be helpful or dangerous. It depends on how people use it.
It may improve productivity.	benefício provável	AI may improve productivity by helping with summaries and reports.
It might make some skills less valued.	risco possível	AI might make some technical skills less valued over time.
Humans still need to...	colocar papel humano	Humans still need to ask good questions and interpret the results.
The future of work may be more flexible.	opinião sobre carreira	The future of work may be more flexible, but also more demanding.

Data analyst speaking frame

As a data analyst, I think AI might help with repetitive tasks, but humans still need to understand the business context. A tool can generate numbers, but people need to ask the right questions and decide what the numbers actually mean.

11. Describing people and lifestyle habits

These chunks help you describe routine, personality and work-life patterns.

Expression	Sentido	Natural example
rarely leaves home	quase não sai de casa	During the week, she rarely leaves home because she works full-time.
works online	trabalha online	She works online and spends hours looking at dashboards.
drinks too much coffee	bebe café demais	She drinks too much coffee when she has tight deadlines.
tight deadlines	prazos apertados	Tight deadlines make people more stressed and less social.
checks social media every few minutes	checa redes o tempo todo	Some people check social media every few minutes without realizing it.
never answers messages	nunca responde mensagens	He never answers messages, so people think he is rude.
wakes up extremely early	acorda muito cedo	People who wake up extremely early usually have a very structured routine.
studies during lunch breaks	estuda no intervalo	She studies English during lunch breaks when the day is not too chaotic.
complains about deadlines constantly	reclama de prazos sem parar	He complains about deadlines constantly, but he always delivers.
travels constantly	viaja constantemente	Some jobs look exciting because people travel constantly, but it can be exhausting.

Describe someone

- Describe a data analyst using 3 expressions from this page.
- Describe a very social friend using 3 expressions from this page.
- Describe someone mysterious using may, might or must.

12. Food, home and friends

A small-talk upgrade for real life: staying home, going out, eating, cooking and seeing friends.

Expression	Uso / Sentido	Natural example
I'm craving...	quando bate vontade de comer algo	I'm craving something sweet after work.
I feel like cooking...	vontade de cozinhar	I feel like cooking something simple but tasty tonight.
nothing fancy	nada elaborado/chique	I want something good, but nothing fancy.
comfort food	comida que dá conforto	Pasta is my comfort food when I'm tired.
homemade	feito em casa	Homemade food feels better on a rainy day.
stay in	ficar em casa	I'd rather stay in and watch a documentary tonight.
go out for dinner	sair para jantar	On weekends, I like going out for dinner with friends.
grab something to eat	comer alguma coisa de forma casual	We can grab something to eat after work.
have people over	receber pessoas em casa	I like having people over when I cook something nice.
catch up with friends	colocar o papo em dia	I like going to a friend's house to catch up and eat something good.
bring something to share	levar algo para dividir	If I go to a friend's house, I usually bring something to share.
I'm in the mood for...	estou no clima/vontade de	I'm in the mood for a mystery movie and homemade food.

Natural mini-dialogues

Situation	Possible answer
Friend: What do you want to do tonight?	Honestly, I'm in the mood to stay in, cook something homemade and watch a mystery documentary.
Friend: Do you want to go out?	Maybe. I don't want anything fancy, but we could grab something to eat.
Friend: What should we bring?	Let's bring something to share. Maybe dessert or something salty.

Speaking templates

Use these when you need to speak for 1 to 3 minutes.

1. Content reflection template

I watched/read/listened to _____. It was about _____. What kept me hooked was _____. At first, I thought _____, but later _____. I feel like the story says a lot about _____.

Example

I watched a true crime documentary about a woman who disappeared. It was about her last known steps and the people around her. What kept me hooked was the fact that the evidence kept changing. At first, I thought she had been kidnapped, but later I thought she might have planned everything. I feel like the story says a lot about how little we know about people's private lives.

2. Theory template

One possible explanation is that _____. She/he may have _____. Another possibility is that she/he might have _____. But because _____, she/he must have _____.

3. Smart opinion template

I feel like _____. I can see why people think _____. At the same time, _____. One clear example is _____. So, from my perspective, _____.

4. Tech opinion template

As someone who works with data, I think _____. AI may _____, but it might also _____. Humans still need to _____. In many cases, the problem is not the tool itself, but how people use it.

Weekly practice plan

A simple way to put the expressions into your routine.

Day	Função	Task
Day 1	noticing	Choose one section. Highlight 5 expressions that sound useful for your real life.
Day 2	personalizing	Write 5 sentences about your work, home routine, friends, food or content habits.
Day 3	speaking	Record a 1-minute audio using at least 3 expressions.
Day 4	theory practice	Create 3 theories about a strange situation using may, might and must.
Day 5	past theory	Retell a mystery using may have, might have and must have.
Weekend	real-life English	Use English to describe something you watched, cooked, read or discussed with friends.

Expression tracker

Expression I want to use	My sentence	Used in speaking

My own examples

Use this page to create sentences that sound like you.

1. My content habits

2. My theory about a strange situation

3. My opinion about AI, work or society

Favorite chunks

Write the expressions that you want to steal and reuse.

Chunk	When I can use it	My example